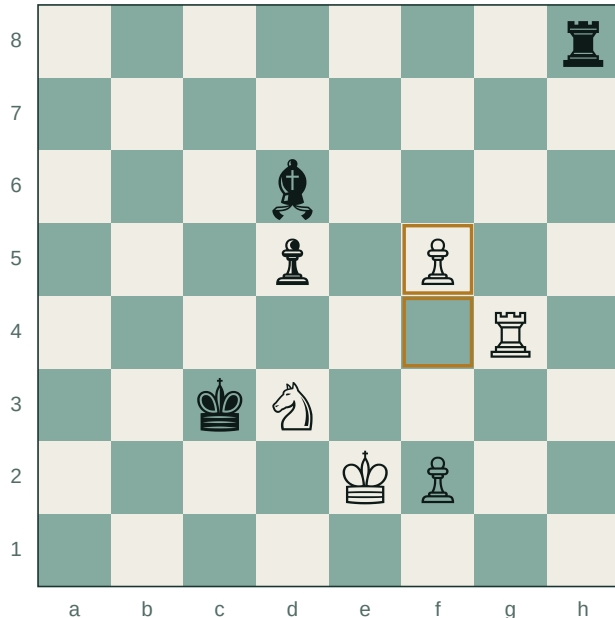


Deflection tactics: Black, move 67

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 67.f5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

67...Re8+ 68. Kf3 Kxd3

67...Re8+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **68.Kf3**.

68...Kxd3 The king captures the knight on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e2. Geometrically undefended: rook on g4. Check for tactical protection.